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A Brief Survey of the N-GOON Problem

B. Wanker

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Abstract

The N-GOON problem asks: given a dorm, how many residents can simultaneously attend to their personal business without any two participants hearing each other through shared walls or ceilings.

1 Classical Gooning

Early work models dorm rooms as vertices and shared walls as edges, yielding a planar graph $G = (V, E)$. A gooning schedule is a proper coloring of G where each color corresponds to a time slot.

Wanker et al. [1] proved that the Morewood Gardens third floor graph is bipartite. Thus, the entire floor may be scheduled with only two time slots (e.g. 10–11 PM and 11–12 AM). More generally, any dorm floor requires at most four slots by the four color theorem.

Roommates within a room must subdivide their assigned hour equally. Empirically, compliance with this protocol is poor. It has been noted the above result fails most often during finals week, when demand spikes dramatically.

2 Multi-Floor Gooning

The classical model incorrectly assumes floors and ceilings provide meaningful sound insulation. When vertical transmission is considered, the dorm becomes a 3D lattice graph. The resulting structure contains $K_{3,3}$ subgraphs, including edge contractions (notably, edging the occupants often causes the opposite of a contraction). As a consequence, determining a valid schedule becomes NP-complete; informally, the problem is harder than the occupants.

3 Weighted Gooning

Walls transmit sound unevenly. For example, the wall between rooms 312 and 314 appears to be made of paper mâché.

Jack's Son et al. [2] therefore introduce edge weights $w_{uv} \in [0, 1]$ representing acoustic transmission between rooms u and v. The objective is to minimize the total interference $I = \sum_{(u,v)\in E} w_{uv} x_u x_v$ where x_u indicates whether room u is active and E represents the set of all rooms. Unfortunately, computing the optimal schedule is again NP-hard.

4 Hyper-Gooning

Recent cultural developments have complicated the model. In particular, the rise of group sessions invalidates the graph.

Maille et al. [3] model these events using a k-uniform hypergraph in which hyperedges represent potential collaborative gatherings. The resulting hyper-gooning scheduling problem is provably hard with no practical solutions.

5 Conclusion

Each extension of the model pushes the N-GOON problem deeper into computational intractability. We therefore recommend that CMU designs dorm floors to be bipartite, installs ceilings thicker than a tortilla, and advises first-years to invest in noise-canceling headphones.

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Survey Says!

From the Forbes Ave McDonald's

WP
2 for 6 Fillet-o-Fish Enjoyer

The ancient Greeks, having nothing better to do with their time, came up with six words for love: agape (unconditional love), eros (sexual love), philia (brotherly love), storge (parental love), philautia (self love), and xenia (hospitable love). Less widely known is that the ancient Greeks also invented six words for hate, which they came up with shortly after inventing trigonometry: arc-agape, arc-eros, arc-philia, arc-storge, arc-philautia, and arc-xenia. One lesser known perk of attending school in the Pittsburgh area is getting to experience all of these sentiments in their natural breeding ground, the McDonald's on Forbes Avenue. For the cheap price of a 2 for 6 Fillet-o-Fish, you can experience the full spectrum of hatred available to the human soul.

The inverse of agape, called the highest form of love and often described in a religious or charitable context, is a general sense of ill-will towards yourself, your fellow man, and your own existence. It is a more complex concept than arc-philautia, which is the classical sense of self-hate you feel as you eat whatever you ordered. Arc-agape is a more just, higher-minded feeling: everything is awful, not just you. This is something obvious even to PRT route planners; if you ever find yourself taking a bus from campus downtown to jump off a bridge, you are able to stop at the Forbes McDonald's for a burger first.

Decency to guests and travellers as an obligation is a concept that has developed in many cultures, and one that has successfully been squashed here. The un-American lack of drive-through and the location of the McDonald's naturally contribute to arc-xenia, or the inverse of hospitable love: during the lunchtime rush, a general sense of animosity comes with the adrenaline of waiting for your order number to be shouted out.

The concepts of arc-eros and arc-storge, the inverses of parental and romantic love, are more subtly demonstrated at the Forbes McDonald's but manifest there nonetheless. Any connoisseur of the location will notice that, after 11 PM on weekdays, the location is infested with underclassmen in the prime of their youth. The malevolent aura inside the McDonald's forces one's mind to drift towards hating the young. Hate in the sexual sense, i.e. arc-eros, can take on a multitude of meetings, but here specifically refers to the disdain one feels towards that same youth engaging in activities as they wait for their order. Get a room, damn.

The inverse of love between friends, arc-philia, is interestingly demonstrated in this location, in the sense that the feeling persists regardless of whether one is dining alone or with friends. The flickering of the lights or chemical composition of the air sends subliminal messages to diners: nobody cares about you, and your jokes aren't funny.

This begs the question: if the Forbes Ave McDonald's is so bad, why do I keep coming back? Once again, we return to the Greeks. In addition to coming up with funny-sounding names for emotions, they also came up with funny-sounding ideas about the afterlife. Plato speculated that souls that are impure return to Earth to suffer, with the worst offenders returning as animals or even women. I propose, then, the obvious conclusion that the Forbes Ave McDonald's is actually a sort of purgatory from which one may eventually escape after sufficient purification. Until then, it looks like I'll keep going back.

They will greet us as sexual liberators

Allyn
Author of the Twinkuine Mystique

The saddest day of my life has been, without question, the death of Pitt's beloved former vice chancellor Dick Cheney. On the 4-month anniversary of this somber occasion, I'd like to republish the 2003 interview another of our staffwriters had with him, which represents the purest encapsulation of his fighting spirit.
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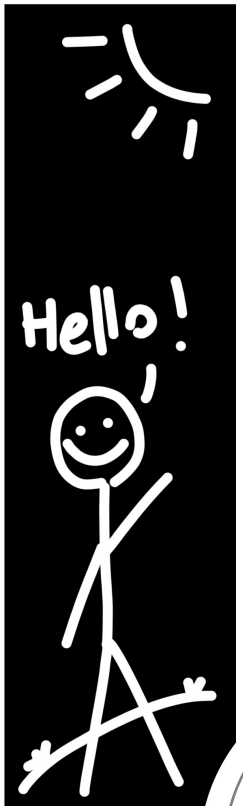
Dick Cheney: Now, I think things have gotten so bad inside CMU, from the standpoint of the students, my belief is we will, in fact, be greeted as sexual liberators. And the chancellor's made it very clear that our purpose there is, if we are forced to do this, will in fact be to stand up a social order that's representative of the students sexual desires, hopefully democratic due respect for consent, and it, obviously, involves a major commitment by the University of Pittsburgh, but we think it's a commitment worth making. And we don't have the option anymore of simply laying back and hoping that events at Carnegie Mellon will not constitute a threat to Pitt. Clearly, 12 years after the Pitt-CMU War, we're back in a situation where she does constitute a threat.

"Roan Tysh": If your analysis is not correct, and we're not treated as sexual liberators, but as lustful pursuers, and the students begin to reject us, particularly in Wean Hall, do you think the students of Pitt are prepared for a long, unsexy, and dry battle with significant Panther casualties?

Dick Cheney: Well, I don't think it's likely to unfold that way, Roan, because I really do believe that we will be greeted as sexual liberators. I've talked with a lot of CMU students in the last several months myself, had them to my sex dungeon. The chancellor and I have met with them, various groups and individuals, people who have devoted their lives from the outside to trying to change things inside CMU. And like Justin McLeod who's a founder at Hinge, an alumnus, he's written great books about the subject, knows the college intimately, and is a part of the social opposition and resistance. The read we get on the people of Carnegie Mellon is there is no question that they want to bang hot singles and they will welcome Pitt as sexual liberators when we come to do that.



THIS SPACE HAS BEEN ANNEXED BY BENNER ROGERS

The REAL and UNADULTERATED Truth about Spring Break

Jupiter
Spring Break Realist

Hello, readers of this esteemed magazine. I come to you with the TRUTH about Spring Break. I must write quickly before they find me. I'm not supposed to be telling you this…

This semester I enrolled in 15-451, a simple algorithms course to fulfill my SCS requirements. In the first half of the semester, I have struggled. The notes are little more than incomprehensible scrawl and Office Hours seem to be located in a building that only occurs in dreams. With the dawning of Spring Break, I was sure I was going to fail the class. As I wandered the deserted halls of Wean, desperately looking for people to share my sorrows with, I heard the distant sounds of a lecture.

I climbed the stairs, up and up. The sound grew closer, never in my reach. Going mad, desperate to find this mysterious lecture, I found the roof. There, I saw them. Seven or eight hooded figures, all engaging in discussion of efficient data structures, the content of 15-451. The notes, lit by candlelight, were perfectly clear. As I approached closer, the topic of conversation switched to job searching. Each hooded person produced a clean, perfect resume. They all had jobs for the summer, with housing and benefits.

Horrified, I ran from the scene, back down the stairs until I was sure they wouldn't find me. What sort of cult had I stumbled upon? I was unsure. Shaken, I returned to my apartment. I attempted to sleep, nothing came of it. The conversation of the hooded figures was seared in my brain.

I attempted to brush off the memories, but I seemed to hear the voices from the roof anytime I entered Wean. Finally, I ventured back to the roof. There, they were waiting for me. They drew me in, handed me a cloak, and sat me down. I lost track of time. My brain just seemed to soak in everything. I learned the secrets of algorithms, how to get a job, how to find a wife, and how to be truly happy.

I still didn't know who they were. As I thought about writing this, a voice in the back of my mind said I shouldn't. Yet I couldn't keep this to myself. There, on the crown of Wean Hall, lied the answers to 15-451 and life itself.

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Interview with Hemingway himself
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